

# JAMES MITCHELL

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Staff Engineer with 6 years of experience building scalable backend systems and leading technical initiatives across distributed teams. I've spent the last four years at growth-stage startups in the fintech and SaaS spaces, where I've owned the architecture for services handling millions of daily transactions. I'm equally comfortable deep in the codebase and working with product teams to align engineering decisions with business objectives. Based in Bristol, I'm looking for roles where I can take on significant architectural ownership.

## WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

TechFlow Solutions

techflow.io

Bristol, United Kingdom

March 2023 - Present

Led the redesign of our core payment processing system, reducing latency by 60% and improving reliability to 99.98% uptime through event-driven architecture and database optimisation

Established engineering standards and code review practices across a team of 8 engineers, implementing automated linting, testing pipelines, and deployment protocols

Mentored 4 junior engineers through pair programming and structured feedback, resulting in 2 promotions to mid-level roles within 18 months

Architected a real-time data warehouse using Apache Kafka and PostgreSQL, enabling product and analytics teams to access metrics with sub-minute latency

Senior Software Engineer

FinanceCore Ltd

financecore.co

Bristol, United Kingdom

July 2021 - February 2023

Designed and implemented a microservices migration strategy, breaking down a monolithic Rails application into 6 containerised services using Docker and Kubernetes, reducing deployment times from 40 minutes to 8 minutes

Took ownership of our transaction settlement system, building resilience features including idempotency guarantees and circuit breaker patterns that reduced customer-facing incidents by 75%

Collaborated with the security team to implement end-to-end encryption for sensitive customer data and established audit logging across all API endpoints

Built a comprehensive monitoring and observability stack using Prometheus, Grafana, and ELK, enabling faster root cause analysis of production issues

Mid-Level Backend Engineer

DataSync Networks

datasync.net

Cheltenham, United Kingdom

September 2019 - June 2021

Developed and maintained REST APIs serving 2+ million monthly active users, focusing on performance optimisation and horizontal scalability across AWS infrastructure

Implemented automated database migration tools and strategies that reduced schema change deployment time by 85% and eliminated manual downtime windows

Built internal CLI tools in Go for common operational tasks, saving the team approximately 10 hours per week in routine maintenance work

Contributed to the adoption of PostgreSQL best practices including partitioning strategies and query optimisation, improving slow query times by 70%

## EDUCATION

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BSc Computer Science

University of Bristol

Bristol, United Kingdom

2017 - 2020

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

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Languages: Python, Go, JavaScript, Ruby, SQL

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, DynamoDB

Backend: Django, Rails, FastAPI, Node.js

Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda), Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform

Tools & Platforms: Git, GitHub, GitLab CI/CD, Jenkins, Datadog, Prometheus

Concepts: Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, System Design, Database Optimisation, API Design

## GITHUB REPOSITORIES

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[github.com/jamesmitchell-dev/transaction-ledger](https://github.com/jamesmitchell-dev/transaction-ledger) - Production-ready transaction settlement library in Python with idempotency and retry logic

[github.com/jamesmitchell-dev/pg-migration-toolkit](https://github.com/jamesmitchell-dev/pg-migration-toolkit) - CLI tool for managing PostgreSQL schema migrations with zero-downtime deployments

[github.com/jamesmitchell-dev/kafka-consumer-patterns](https://github.com/jamesmitchell-dev/kafka-consumer-patterns) - Collection of fault-tolerant Kafka consumer implementations in Go

[github.com/jamesmitchell-dev/api-rate-limiter](https://github.com/jamesmitchell-dev/api-rate-limiter) - Distributed rate limiting service using Redis with sliding window algorithm